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MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2025

President, Democrats to meet on budget

Deadline hours away for shutdown of agencies

By Michael Gold
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump will meet with the four top congressional leaders at the White House on Monday, the day before a deadline to avert a government shutdown, the lawmakers said.

Congress faces a Tuesday deadline to fund the government, which will require lawmakers to agree on a spending measure that can win at least 60 votes in the Senate. But Republicans control only 53 seats and need support from Democrats, who have been demanding that GOP leaders and Trump negotiate with them.

But even as leaders of both parties agreed to a meeting, it was unclear whether Trump intended to reach a bipartisan compromise or if he was summoning Democrats to press them to accept Republicans' funding proposal.

In an interview on CNN, Speaker Mike Johnson said Sunday that the president was "always open to discussion." But when pressed on whether Trump intended to negotiate a deal, Johnson side-stepped the question and accused Democrats of holding government funds hostage for "partisan demands."

Senator Chuck Schumer of New York, the Democratic leader, said on NBC's "Meet the Press" that Monday's meeting was "only a first step" and

SHUTDOWN, Page A7

Descending on D.C.: a cloak of uncertainty

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — In what has come to feel like a regular occurrence, Congress is staring down a government shutdown starting at 12:01 a.m. on Wednesday, and there is no indication yet either party has a plan to avoid it.

This time, however, there's a new level of uncertainty about how things will unfold, both because of the politics surrounding the stalemate and because of the personnel and policies of the Trump administration.

Here's what we know — and what we don't — about how a shutdown might unfold.

Both parties show little incentive to negotiate

As the deadline nears, most of the communications from Republicans and Democrats are more focused on convincing Americans the other side is to blame for a shutdown, arguing the other is unreasonable, than coming to the table.

Democrats have argued that since Republicans need their votes to meet the 60-vote threshold to advance legislation in the Senate, they should negotiate with Democrats to include

UNCERTAINTY, Page A7

Gunfire, flames, terror at Sunday service

Attacker rams pickup into chapel; at least four killed as Michigan church left in ashes

By Isabella Volmert
and Corey Williams
ASSOCIATED PRESS

GRAND BLANC TOWNSHIP, Mich. — A gunman in a pickup truck smashed through the doors of a Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints chapel, opened fire, and set the building ablaze, killing at least four people and injuring eight. Police shot and killed the suspect, authorities said.

The attack occurred at about 10:25 a.m. The gunman got out of the four-door pickup with two American flags in the

truck and started shooting, Police Chief William Renye told reporters. He apparently used gas to start the fire and also had explosive devices but it wasn't clear if he used them, said James Dier of the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives.

Authorities identified the shooter as Thomas Jacob Sanford, 40, of the neighboring small town of Burton. The FBI is leading the investigation and considered it an "act of targeted violence," said Ruben Coleman, a special agent in charge

MICHIGAN, Page A6



JULIE J. @MALKOWSKI16/APRIL VIA AP

Flames engulfed a Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints chapel outside of Flint, Mich.



PHOTOS BY JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Instructor Jason Poissant offered tips on sea survival at the National Offshore Wind Institute in New Bedford.

Trump's policy on wind power generates frustration, concern

Sector had reinvigorated New Bedford. Now workers fear loss of jobs.

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

NEW BEDFORD — The wind howled as Sonia Brito, clad in a white hard hat and yellow vest, looked out at scallopers, lobster boats, and trawlers crowding the waterfront of New England's premier fishing port.

Not long ago, the fishing fleet was one of the few sources of good-paying jobs in New Bedford for blue-collar workers such as Brito. But here at the top of a white, 250-foot pillar, Brito had found a different way to earn a living as a millwright: connecting massive



COURTESY OF SONIA BRITO

Sonia Brito doubled her pay when becoming a millworker apprentice.

blades and tower sections for wind farms off the coast of Massachusetts.

"For kids like myself who went to a vocational school, this is a perfect industry that the United States needs," said Brito, 22, of New Bedford. "All we really have here is fishing, so you either become a fisherman or leave. This gives people another option."

That option, however, may not be available as long as President Trump's assault on offshore wind energy threatens to unravel tens of millions of dollars invested here to build a hub of docks, terminals, and training programs to support the burgeoning indus-

WIND, Page A10



Monday: Sun, high clouds.
High 75-80, low 59-64.

Tuesday: See Monday.
High 70-75, low 53-58.
High tide: 5:01, 5:09.

Sunrise: 6:39. Sunset: 6:29.
Weather and comics, **D4-5**.
Obituaries, **B6**.

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Repetitive hits to the head during sports can kill brain cells and may lead to long-term brain damage, even before the onset of chronic traumatic encephalopathy, a BU study determined. **B1.**

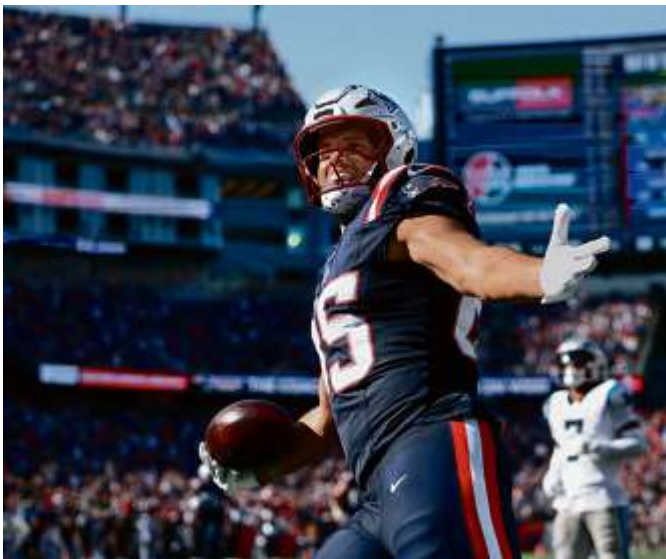
Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, on the eve of meeting with President Trump, said Israel is working on a new cease-fire plan with the White House. **A6.**

Forward Al Horford, one of the most beloved Celtics, has signed with the Golden State Warriors. **C1.**

The long, complicated, and sometimes tortuous effort to build a tower over South Station is near completion. **D1.**

The Red Sox will face the New York Yankees in the playoffs, starting Tuesday. **C1.**

CRUISING TO VICTORY



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots tight end Hunter Henry celebrated scoring one of six New England touchdowns Sunday at Gillette Stadium. The 42-13 thrashing of the Carolina Panthers was the team's first blowout win since 2021. **C1.**

As firms' use of AI goes up, hiring goes down

Some local CEOs tout streamlining to their investors

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

A number of Boston-area companies say they are starting to hire fewer workers in certain areas due to the widespread adoption of artificial intelligence tools. From software to online health firms, local executives said they are using the technology to enhance capabilities but also reduce costs and boost efficiency.

Economists have argued over whether AI will be a transformative technology that increases

productivity or an overhyped waste of money. While some see massive job losses in vulnerable industries, others have predicted more new jobs will be created than lost.

Chief executive Jason Robins of DraftKings said the online gambling company is going to be "able to basically replace what would have been human hires with AI agents and also reduce [workers] in certain areas as well." Robins made the remarks at an investor conference this month.

Under a new policy at DraftKings, he added, "you can't hire anybody next year unless you've already proven you can't do the same job with an AI agent."

WORKERS, Page A10